AMAN RAJ

Program Manager | Program Delivery | Strategy and Operations

Bokaro, Jharkhand, India | +91 96619 07313 | p18amanr@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/p18amanr | Open to Relocation or Remote

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Program management professional with 6+ years owning end-to-end delivery of large-scale, multi-site programs across four states, spanning research operations, healthcare operations and manufacturing. Owned statewide programs covering 243 assembly seats, 70 constituencies and 325,000+ samples from design through final delivery against fixed, non-negotiable dates, planning and controlling an INR 1.2 Crore per-cycle operations budget. Runs delivery through structured program governance, RAID-based risk management, weekly executive reviews to CEO and COO level, and a daily cross-functional cadence across Operations, Data, Analytics, Project Management and Field. Built an analytics function from zero to 10 analysts with 8 direct reports, scaled field operations to a 600+ agent workforce, and recovered a stalled statewide program to close within three days of its original deadline. MBA, IIM Indore. Lean Six Sigma Green Belt.

SKILLS

Program Management: Program Planning, PMO Setup, Status Reporting, Change Management, Program Design and Rollout, Program Delivery, Program Governance, Delivery Cadence, RAID and Risk Management, Issue and Escalation Management, Timeline and Milestone Ownership, Stakeholder Management, Executive Reporting, Cross-functional Leadership, Program Recovery and Turnaround, Scope Management

Strategy and Operations: Operating Cadence Design, KPI Management, Business Reviews, Decision Support, Prioritization, Budget Planning and Control, Resource Allocation, Capacity Planning, Workforce Planning, Operational Planning, Forecasting, Unit Economics, Data-Driven Decision Making

Operations and Delivery: Multi-Site Operations, Field Operations, Vendor Management, Hiring and Onboarding, Training Program Design, Performance Management, Cost Optimization, Compliance and Audit, Quality Assurance, Incentive Design

Process Excellence: Lean Six Sigma (DMAIC), Process Improvement, Continuous Improvement, SOP Design and Standardization, Root Cause Analysis, Cycle-Time Reduction, Fraud and Bias Controls

AI and Productivity Tools: Generative AI Tools (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini), Prompt Engineering, AI-assisted Research and Analysis, AI-assisted Reporting and Documentation, AI-enabled Workflow Automation

Analytics and Tools: Python, Advanced Excel (Pivot Tables, VLOOKUP), Google Workspace, Google Apps Script, Metabase, Tableau, SAP, SPSS, Slack, KPI Dashboards, Reporting Automation, Operational Analytics, Forecasting Models

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Career Break | *Bokaro, India*

UPSC Civil Services Examination Preparation | May 2025 – Aug 2026

- Full-time preparation for the UPSC Civil Services Examination, with structured study of the Indian economy, public policy, governance and current affairs.

Dhruv Research | *Gurgaon, India* | *Oct 2021 – May 2025*

Reported to the CEO, COO and Director of Operations.

Associate Manager (Program Delivery) | Sep 2024 – May 2025

- Owned a statewide research program across all 70 Delhi constituencies end to end, from program design and sampling methodology through field execution to the final leadership report, delivering 325,000+ collected samples ahead of the committed date.
- Ran a daily cross-functional delivery cadence across Operations, Data, Analytics, Project Management and Field teams, aligning stakeholders to the end-to-end timeline, clearing blockers at source before they reached the critical path and escalating unresolved risks with recommended options.
- Established and ran the executive review cycle, reporting daily to senior management and weekly to the leadership team on progress, open issues and actions taken, using KPI dashboards and a live RAID log to support data-driven decisions across every open risk.
- Planned and controlled an INR 1.2 Crore per-cycle field operations budget covering workforce, travel and vendor spend, owning allocation planning, in-cycle cost tracking and corrective action against delivery targets.
- Led a baseline and pre-poll research program covering all 38 districts and 243 assembly seats, delivering every milestone on schedule against a fixed, non-negotiable end date.
- Directed a 150-member field workforce across the statewide program, owning deployment, daily throughput targets and quality thresholds through the full delivery cycle.
- Deployed and audited a 240-member field force, holding sampling quality and process compliance steady across the cycle through structured monitoring and spot audits.
- Forecasted seat share and vote share to support leadership decision-making, calling 77% of seats correctly with vote share within a 3% margin of error, delivered ahead of the deadline.
- Managed client relationships, translating requirements, issues and escalations into delivery plans for internal teams.
- Built the Analytics Division from zero to 10 analysts with 8 direct reports, defining organization structure, role charters, reporting lines and operating cadence for a function that did not previously exist.

- Owned workforce planning and end-to-end hiring for the division, and designed the onboarding and structured training program that brought new analysts to full productivity on live client deliverables.
- Defined the division's KPIs and ran performance management against them, owning task allocation, daily review huddles and the appraisal cycle.

Senior Associate, Strategy and Operations | Oct 2021 – Aug 2024

- Recovered a statewide program in Gujarat that had produced zero completed constituencies after 15 days, taking operational control, retraining field teams, resetting targets and restructuring agent pay from fixed daily allowance to performance-linked, cutting the projected delay from 15 days to 3.
- Reduced cost per sample from INR 400+ to INR 280+, a ~30% unit-cost reduction achieved by eliminating avoidable spend and raising first-pass sampling quality, which removed the need for repeat collection.
- Scaled the field workforce to 600+ agents for a multi-district program and built the onboarding and training program that made the scale-up deliverable, training and onboarding 1,000+ field agents and supervisors across programs.
- Managed manpower supply and call center vendors, contracting field agent hiring capacity and holding vendor partners to defined sampling quality standards through structured monitoring.
- Reduced field travel expenditure by INR 8 Lakh against the operations budget by building a latitude-longitude route optimization model for field team movement planning.
- Designed the field SOPs and monitoring routines that standardized execution across every geography and gave leadership consistent, comparable KPI visibility for the first time.
- Automated field team dashboards using Google Apps Script and Metabase, providing live operational visibility into sampling targets, representative-sample gaps, KPI performance and sample rejection reasons.
- Directed a 180-agent field force and the daily reporting system against a compressed delivery timeline, closing with no slippage, and built a respondent-level fraud detection control that removed suspect interviews before they entered the working sample.

Pristyn Care | *Gurgaon, India*

Manager, Medical Services | Dec 2020 – Oct 2021

- Built a city-wise demand forecasting model that became the basis for in-house capacity planning and drove a measurable increase in practitioner utilization across the network.
- Onboarded 23 practitioners across Tier 2 and Tier 3 cities, redesigning onboarding end to end and replacing an inconsistent intake with a standardized week-long orientation and training program.
- Established ongoing performance measurement for the practitioner network against defined service and utilization metrics, giving leadership visibility into network productivity.

Tata Steel | *Jamshedpur, India*

Maintenance Assistant, Coke Plant Operations | Jun 2016 – Jun 2018

- Ramped a 1.75 MTPA plant to full operation in a record 35 days as part of the commissioning team, working to a fixed start-up schedule.
- Reduced machine cycle time by 20 minutes through operational re-sequencing, increasing throughput capacity on the line.
- Led root cause analysis on repeat equipment failures and commissioned a dust collector system, tracking corrective actions and KPI records in SAP.

EDUCATION

Master of Business Administration (Post Graduate Programme in Management), 72.14% | 2018 – 2020
Indian Institute of Management (IIM) Indore

Bachelor of Arts, Economics (Honours), 63.63%, Rank 5 of 132 | 2016
Nalanda Open University, Patna

CERTIFICATIONS

- Lean Six Sigma Green Belt, KPMG at IIM Indore
- Operations Analytics, Wharton Online (University of Pennsylvania)
- Data Visualization with Tableau, UC Davis

PROJECTS, ACHIEVEMENTS AND LEADERSHIP

- HR Analytics Framework, Avtec Business Solutions: Analyzed attrition drivers and cost-to-sales ratio and built the business case for reducing attrition from 13.9% to 11.2%.
- Go-to-Market Study, Luminous Power: Ran 63 stakeholder interviews and SPSS-based segmentation to define buyer personas and inform market entry positioning.
- Top 5 percentile in Operations Management and Pricing among 500+ students, IIM Indore (2020); Runners-up, KPMG Six Sigma Competition.
- Campus Finalist, Mahindra War Room (2019); Campus Runners-up, Asian Paints Canvas (2019), among 500+ competing teams.
- Senior Member, Udaan and Utsaha, IIM Indore: drove 8,000+ runner footfall and raised INR 2.5 Lakh in sponsorship revenue.